



FINAL PROJECT · COHORT AWARDS

Final Project Leaderboard

Claude Course for Professionals

A public-vote leaderboard for the cohort's final projects — one consistent project card, four award categories, and a live results board for the closing ceremony.

PREPARED BY

Meska AI

Learning & Delivery

PROGRAM

Claude for Professionals

DELIVERABLE

Final Project Awards

CLASSIFICATION

Internal — Confidential

OVERVIEW

Four Awards, One Public Vote

Every project is judged by the cohort itself, on the same information, across four categories.

4

AWARD CATEGORIES

100%

PUBLIC VOTE

1

STANDARD CARD
FORMAT

Live

RESULTS BOARD

Instead of separate criteria per category, every project is presented with **one identical set of details**. Voters read the same card for each project and decide for themselves which project deserves each award — Best ROI, Best Technical, Best Creative, and Cohort Choice.

Why this works: a single consistent format keeps the vote fair — no project is dressed up differently to chase a category — and it's far simpler to build, present, and vote on live during the ceremony.

The Four Awards

Best ROI

Best Technical

Best Creative

Cohort Choice

A voter can give different votes to different projects across categories — e.g. Project A for ROI, Project B for Technical, Project C for Cohort Choice — all from reading the same card.

SECTION 01

The Standard Project Card

Same nine fields for every project — no category-specific framing.

1 **Project Name + Tagline**

IDENTITY

One line that says what it is, in plain language.

2 **Participant**

NAME & PHOTO

Each project is built by one individual — a single name and photo, not a team list.

3 **Problem Statement**

2–3 SENTENCES

What problem this solves, and for whom.

4 **Solution Overview**

2–3 SENTENCES

What the participant actually built, in plain language.

5 **Demo**

VIDEO OR SCREENSHOTS

30–60 second video, or 3–5 screenshots. People vote with their eyes first.

6 **Impact / ROI Note**

TIME OR COST SAVED

A number, even an estimate — this is what Best ROI voters look for.

7

Tech Stack & Hard Problem Solved

TOOLS USED

Claude features used (agents, MCP, API, etc.) and one specific hard thing the participant solved — the anchor for Best Technical votes.

8

The Creative Twist

WHAT'S UNEXPECTED

The "aha" or unconventional use case — what Best Creative voters look for.

9

Live Link / Repo

OPTIONAL

For anyone who wants to try the project or look at the code themselves.

Voting Mechanics

One card, four vote buttons, real-time tally.

Beneath every project card, four vote buttons appear — a voter can tap into any category for that project:

Best ROI

Best Technical

Best Creative

Cohort Choice

RULE	RECOMMENDATION
Votes per person / category	One vote per person per category — prevents any single voter from dominating a result.
Self-voting	Decide upfront whether participants can vote for their own project, and state the rule clearly on the voting page.
Voting window	Opens once all project cards are published; closes shortly before the awards reveal to build suspense.
Project order	Randomize per voter session to avoid a "first project gets more votes" bias.
Before voting	Encourage — or require — voters to view all project cards before their first vote is accepted.

Open decisions for you: can one voter pick the same project for more than one category, and can a category have more than one vote per voter? Both should be fixed and stated before voting opens.

Solo-participant risk: since each project is built by one individual rather than a team, Cohort Choice can drift toward "who's well-liked" rather than "best project." Keep the participant photo secondary to the project demo on the card, and frame Cohort Choice as *"the project I'd most want to see become real"* rather than a popularity pick.

Live Leaderboard Display

A shared results screen that updates as votes come in.

What It Shows

- All projects, ranked live within each of the 4 categories
- Vote counts updating in real time as the cohort votes
- A clean "reveal" view for the closing ceremony, projected on screen

Why It Works

- Builds energy while project demos are still running
- Keeps the room engaged through every presentation
- Gives a satisfying, suspenseful moment at results time

Suggested Flow

BEFORE

- Publish all project cards in the standard format

DURING DEMOS

- Voting opens; leaderboard updates live on the shared screen

AFTER DEMOS

- Voting window closes

CEREMONY

- Reveal the 4 winners on the leaderboard screen

NEXT STEP

Build the live voting page and leaderboard — project cards in this exact format, four vote buttons per card, live-updating counts, and a projector-friendly results view — ready to plug in each participant's details once the number of projects is confirmed.